THE EPISTLE TO THE

HEBREWS

1 Long ago, at many times and in many ways, God spoke to
our fathers by the prophets, [2]but in these last days he
has spoken to us by his Son, whom he appointed the heir of
all things, through whom also he created the world. [3]He is
the radiance of the glory of God and the exact imprint of his
nature, and he upholds the universe by the word of his power.
After making purification for sins, he sat down at the right
hand of the Majesty on high, [4]having become as much supe-
rior to angels as the name he has inherited is more excellent
than theirs.

[5]For to which of the angels did God ever say,

"You are my Son,
today I have begotten you"?

Or again,

"I will be to him a father,
and he shall be to me a son"?

[6]And again, when he brings the firstborn into the world, he says,

"Let all God's angels worship him."

[7]Of the angels he says,

"He makes his angels winds,
and his ministers a flame of fire."

[8]But of the Son he says,

"Your throne, O God, is forever and ever,
the scepter of uprightness is the scepter of your kingdom.
[9] You have loved righteousness and hated wickedness;
therefore God, your God, has anointed you
with the oil of gladness beyond your companions."

[10]And,

"You, Lord, laid the foundation of the earth in the beginning,
and the heavens are the work of your hands;
[11] they will perish, but you remain;
they will all wear out like a garment,
[12] like a robe you will roll them up,
like a garment they will be changed.
But you are the same,
and your years will have no end."

[13]And to which of the angels has he ever said,

"Sit at my right hand
until I make your enemies a footstool for your feet"?

[14]Are they not all ministering spirits sent out to serve for the sake of those who are to inherit salvation?

2 Therefore we must pay much closer attention to what we have heard, lest we drift away from it. [2]For since the message declared by angels proved to be reliable, and every transgression or disobedience received a just retribution, [3]how shall we escape if we neglect such a great salvation? It was declared at first by the Lord, and it was attested to us by those who heard, [4]while God also bore witness by signs and wonders and various miracles and by gifts of the Holy Spirit distributed according to his will.

[5]For it was not to angels that God subjected the world to come, of which we are speaking. [6]It has been testified somewhere,

"What is man, that you are mindful of him,
or the son of man, that you care for him?
[7] You made him for a little while lower than the angels;
you have crowned him with glory and honor,
[8] putting everything in subjection under his feet."

Now in putting everything in subjection to him, he left nothing outside his control. At present, we do not yet see everything in subjection to him. [9]But we see him who for a little while was made lower than the angels, namely Jesus, crowned with glory and honor because of the suffering of death, so that by the grace of God he might taste death for everyone.

[10]For it was fitting that he, for whom and by whom all
things exist, in bringing many sons to glory, should make
the founder of their salvation perfect through suffering.
[11]For he who sanctifies and those who are sanctified all have
one source. That is why he is not ashamed to call them
brothers, [12]saying,

"I will tell of your name to my brothers;
in the midst of the congregation I will sing
your praise."

[13]And again,

"I will put my trust in him."

And again,

"Behold, I and the children God has given me."

[14]Since therefore the children share in flesh and blood, he
himself likewise partook of the same things, that through
death he might destroy the one who has the power of death,
that is, the devil, [15]and deliver all those who through fear of
death were subject to lifelong slavery. [16]For surely it is not
angels that he helps, but he helps the offspring of Abraham.
[17]Therefore he had to be made like his brothers in every respect,
so that he might become a merciful and faithful high priest
in the service of God, to make propitiation for the sins of the
people. [18]For because he himself has suffered when tempted,
he is able to help those who are being tempted.

3 Therefore, holy brothers, you who share in a heavenly
calling, consider Jesus, the apostle and high priest of our con-
fession, [2]who was faithful to him who appointed him, just
as Moses also was faithful in all God's house. [3]For Jesus has
been counted worthy of more glory than Moses—as much
more glory as the builder of a house has more honor than the
house itself. [4](For every house is built by someone, but the
builder of all things is God.) [5]Now Moses was faithful in all
God's house as a servant, to testify to the things that were to
be spoken later, [6]but Christ is faithful over God's house as a
son. And we are his house, if indeed we hold fast our confi-
dence and our boasting in our hope.

[7]Therefore, as the Holy Spirit says,

"Today, if you hear his voice,
[8] do not harden your hearts as in the rebellion,
on the day of testing in the wilderness,
[9] where your fathers put me to the test
and saw my works for forty years.
[10] Therefore I was provoked with that generation,
and said, 'They always go astray in their heart;
they have not known my ways.'
[11] As I swore in my wrath,
'They shall not enter my rest.'"

[12]Take care, brothers, lest there be in any of you an evil, unbe-
lieving heart, leading you to fall away from the living God.
[13]But exhort one another every day, as long as it is called
"today," that none of you may be hardened by the deceitful-

ness of sin. [14]For we have come to share in Christ, if indeed we
hold our original confidence firm to the end. [15]As it is said,

> "Today, if you hear his voice,
> do not harden your hearts as in the rebellion."

[16]For who were those who heard and yet rebelled? Was it not
all those who left Egypt led by Moses? [17]And with whom was
he provoked for forty years? Was it not with those who sinned,
whose bodies fell in the wilderness? [18]And to whom did he
swear that they would not enter his rest, but to those who
were disobedient? [19]So we see that they were unable to enter
because of unbelief.

4 Therefore, while the promise of entering his rest still
stands, let us fear lest any of you should seem to have failed
to reach it. [2]For good news came to us just as to them, but the
message they heard did not benefit them, because they were
not united by faith with those who listened. [3]For we who have
believed enter that rest, as he has said,

> "As I swore in my wrath,
> 'They shall not enter my rest,'"

although his works were finished from the foundation of
the world. [4]For he has somewhere spoken of the seventh day
in this way: "And God rested on the seventh day from all his
works." [5]And again in this passage he said,

> "They shall not enter my rest."

[6]Since therefore it remains for some to enter it, and those
who formerly received the good news failed to enter because
of disobedience, [7]again he appoints a certain day, "Today,"
saying through David so long afterward, in the words
already quoted,

> "Today, if you hear his voice,
> do not harden your hearts."

[8]For if Joshua had given them rest, God would not have spo-
ken of another day later on. [9]So then, there remains a Sabbath
rest for the people of God, [10]for whoever has entered God's rest
has also rested from his works as God did from his.

[11]Let us therefore strive to enter that rest, so that no one
may fall by the same sort of disobedience. [12]For the word of
God is living and active, sharper than any two-edged sword,
piercing to the division of soul and of spirit, of joints and of
marrow, and discerning the thoughts and intentions of the
heart. [13]And no creature is hidden from his sight, but all are
naked and exposed to the eyes of him to whom we must give
account.

[14]Since then we have a great high priest who has passed
through the heavens, Jesus, the Son of God, let us hold fast
our confession. [15]For we do not have a high priest who is
unable to sympathize with our weaknesses, but one who in
every respect has been tempted as we are, yet without sin.
[16]Let us then with confidence draw near to the throne of
grace, that we may receive mercy and find grace to help in
time of need.

5 For every high priest chosen from among men is appointed to act on behalf of men in relation to God, to offer
gifts and sacrifices for sins. [2]He can deal gently with the
ignorant and wayward, since he himself is beset with weak-
ness. [3]Because of this he is obligated to offer sacrifice for his
own sins just as he does for those of the people. [4]And no one
takes this honor for himself, but only when called by God,
just as Aaron was.

[5]So also Christ did not exalt himself to be made a high
priest, but was appointed by him who said to him,

"You are my Son,
today I have begotten you";

[6]as he says also in another place,

"You are a priest forever,
after the order of Melchizedek."

[7]In the days of his flesh, Jesus offered up prayers and sup-
plications, with loud cries and tears, to him who was able to
save him from death, and he was heard because of his rever-
ence. [8]Although he was a son, he learned obedience through
what he suffered. [9]And being made perfect, he became the
source of eternal salvation to all who obey him, [10]being des-
ignated by God a high priest after the order of Melchizedek.

[11]About this we have much to say, and it is hard to explain,
since you have become dull of hearing. [12]For though by this
time you ought to be teachers, you need someone to teach

you again the basic principles of the oracles of God. You
need milk, not solid food, [13]for everyone who lives on milk
is unskilled in the word of righteousness, since he is a child.
[14]But solid food is for the mature, for those who have their
powers of discernment trained by constant practice to distin-
guish good from evil.

6 Therefore let us leave the elementary doctrine of Christ
and go on to maturity, not laying again a foundation of
repentance from dead works and of faith toward God, [2]and
of instruction about washings, the laying on of hands, the
resurrection of the dead, and eternal judgment. [3]And this
we will do if God permits. [4]For it is impossible, in the case of
those who have once been enlightened, who have tasted the
heavenly gift, and have shared in the Holy Spirit, [5]and have
tasted the goodness of the word of God and the powers of the
age to come, [6]and then have fallen away, to restore them again
to repentance, since they are crucifying once again the Son
of God to their own harm and holding him up to contempt.
[7]For land that has drunk the rain that often falls on it, and
produces a crop useful to those for whose sake it is cultivated,
receives a blessing from God. [8]But if it bears thorns and this-
tles, it is worthless and near to being cursed, and its end is to
be burned.

[9]Though we speak in this way, yet in your case, beloved,
we feel sure of better things—things that belong to salvation.
[10]For God is not unjust so as to overlook your work and the
love that you have shown for his name in serving the saints, as
you still do. [11]And we desire each one of you to show the same

earnestness to have the full assurance of hope until the end,
[12]so that you may not be sluggish, but imitators of those who
through faith and patience inherit the promises.

[13]For when God made a promise to Abraham, since he had
no one greater by whom to swear, he swore by himself, [14]say-
ing, "Surely I will bless you and multiply you." [15]And thus
Abraham, having patiently waited, obtained the promise.
[16]For people swear by something greater than themselves,
and in all their disputes an oath is final for confirmation. [17]So
when God desired to show more convincingly to the heirs of
the promise the unchangeable character of his purpose, he
guaranteed it with an oath, [18]so that by two unchangeable
things, in which it is impossible for God to lie, we who have
fled for refuge might have strong encouragement to hold
fast to the hope set before us. [19]We have this as a sure and
steadfast anchor of the soul, a hope that enters into the inner
place behind the curtain, [20]where Jesus has gone as a forerun-
ner on our behalf, having become a high priest forever after
the order of Melchizedek.

7 For this Melchizedek, king of Salem, priest of the Most
High God, met Abraham returning from the slaughter of
the kings and blessed him, [2]and to him Abraham appor-
tioned a tenth part of everything. He is first, by translation of
his name, king of righteousness, and then he is also king of
Salem, that is, king of peace. [3]He is without father or mother
or genealogy, having neither beginning of days nor end of life,
but resembling the Son of God he continues a priest forever.

[4]See how great this man was to whom Abraham the patri-
arch gave a tenth of the spoils! [5]And those descendants of Levi
who receive the priestly office have a commandment in the
law to take tithes from the people, that is, from their broth-
ers, though these also are descended from Abraham. [6]But this
man who does not have his descent from them received tithes
from Abraham and blessed him who had the promises. [7]It is
beyond dispute that the inferior is blessed by the superior.
[8]In the one case tithes are received by mortal men, but in the
other case, by one of whom it is testified that he lives. [9]One
might even say that Levi himself, who receives tithes, paid
tithes through Abraham, [10]for he was still in the loins of his
ancestor when Melchizedek met him.

[11]Now if perfection had been attainable through the
Levitical priesthood (for under it the people received the
law), what further need would there have been for another
priest to arise after the order of Melchizedek, rather than one
named after the order of Aaron? [12]For when there is a change
in the priesthood, there is necessarily a change in the law as
well. [13]For the one of whom these things are spoken belonged
to another tribe, from which no one has ever served at the
altar. [14]For it is evident that our Lord was descended from
Judah, and in connection with that tribe Moses said nothing
about priests.

[15]This becomes even more evident when another priest
arises in the likeness of Melchizedek, [16]who has become a
priest, not on the basis of a legal requirement concerning

bodily descent, but by the power of an indestructible life.
[17]For it is witnessed of him,

"You are a priest forever,
after the order of Melchizedek."

[18]For on the one hand, a former commandment is set aside
because of its weakness and uselessness [19](for the law made
nothing perfect); but on the other hand, a better hope is
introduced, through which we draw near to God.

[20]And it was not without an oath. For those who formerly
became priests were made such without an oath, [21]but this one
was made a priest with an oath by the one who said to him:

"The Lord has sworn
and will not change his mind,
'You are a priest forever.'"

[22]This makes Jesus the guarantor of a better covenant.

[23]The former priests were many in number, because they
were prevented by death from continuing in office, [24]but he
holds his priesthood permanently, because he continues for-
ever. [25]Consequently, he is able to save to the uttermost those
who draw near to God through him, since he always lives to
make intercession for them.

[26]For it was indeed fitting that we should have such a high
priest, holy, innocent, unstained, separated from sinners,
and exalted above the heavens. [27]He has no need, like those
high priests, to offer sacrifices daily, first for his own sins

and then for those of the people, since he did this once for
all when he offered up himself. [28]For the law appoints men
in their weakness as high priests, but the word of the oath,
which came later than the law, appoints a Son who has been
made perfect forever.

8 Now the point in what we are saying is this: we have such a
high priest, one who is seated at the right hand of the throne
of the Majesty in heaven, [2]a minister in the holy places, in the
true tent that the Lord set up, not man. [3]For every high priest
is appointed to offer gifts and sacrifices; thus it is necessary
for this priest also to have something to offer. [4]Now if he were
on earth, he would not be a priest at all, since there are priests
who offer gifts according to the law. [5]They serve a copy and
shadow of the heavenly things. For when Moses was about to
erect the tent, he was instructed by God, saying, "See that you
make everything according to the pattern that was shown you
on the mountain." [6]But as it is, Christ has obtained a ministry
that is as much more excellent than the old as the covenant
he mediates is better, since it is enacted on better promises.
[7]For if that first covenant had been faultless, there would have
been no occasion to look for a second.

[8]For he finds fault with them when he says:

"Behold, the days are coming, declares the Lord,
when I will establish a new covenant with the
house of Israel
and with the house of Judah,

9 not like the covenant that I made with their
fathers
on the day when I took them by the hand to
bring them out of the land of Egypt.
For they did not continue in my covenant,
and so I showed no concern for them, declares
the Lord.
10 For this is the covenant that I will make with the
house of Israel
after those days, declares the Lord:
I will put my laws into their minds,
and write them on their hearts,
and I will be their God,
and they shall be my people.
11 And they shall not teach, each one his neighbor
and each one his brother, saying, 'Know the Lord,'
for they shall all know me,
from the least of them to the greatest.
12 For I will be merciful toward their iniquities,
and I will remember their sins no more."

13 In speaking of a new covenant, he makes the first one obsolete. And what is becoming obsolete and growing old is ready to vanish away.

9 Now even the first covenant had regulations for worship and an earthly place of holiness. 2 For a tent was prepared, the first section, in which were the lampstand and the table and the bread of the Presence. It is called the Holy Place. 3 Behind

the second curtain was a second section called the Most Holy Place, 4 having the golden altar of incense and the ark of the covenant covered on all sides with gold, in which was a golden urn holding the manna, and Aaron's staff that budded, and the tablets of the covenant. 5 Above it were the cherubim of glory overshadowing the mercy seat. Of these things we cannot now speak in detail.

6 These preparations having thus been made, the priests go regularly into the first section, performing their ritual duties, 7 but into the second only the high priest goes, and he but once a year, and not without taking blood, which he offers for himself and for the unintentional sins of the people. 8 By this the Holy Spirit indicates that the way into the holy places is not yet opened as long as the first section is still standing 9 (which is symbolic for the present age). According to this arrangement, gifts and sacrifices are offered that cannot perfect the conscience of the worshiper, 10 but deal only with food and drink and various washings, regulations for the body imposed until the time of reformation.

11 But when Christ appeared as a high priest of the good things that have come, then through the greater and more perfect tent (not made with hands, that is, not of this creation) 12 he entered once for all into the holy places, not by means of the blood of goats and calves but by means of his own blood, thus securing an eternal redemption. 13 For if the blood of goats and bulls, and the sprinkling of defiled persons with the ashes of a heifer, sanctify for the purification of the flesh, 14 how much more will the blood of Christ, who

through the eternal Spirit offered himself without blemish
to God, purify our conscience from dead works to serve the
living God.

[15] Therefore he is the mediator of a new covenant, so that
those who are called may receive the promised eternal inher-
itance, since a death has occurred that redeems them from
the transgressions committed under the first covenant. [16] For
where a will is involved, the death of the one who made it must
be established. [17] For a will takes effect only at death, since it is
not in force as long as the one who made it is alive. [18] Therefore
not even the first covenant was inaugurated without blood.
[19] For when every commandment of the law had been declared
by Moses to all the people, he took the blood of calves and
goats, with water and scarlet wool and hyssop, and sprinkled
both the book itself and all the people, [20] saying, "This is the
blood of the covenant that God commanded for you." [21] And in
the same way he sprinkled with the blood both the tent and
all the vessels used in worship. [22] Indeed, under the law almost
everything is purified with blood, and without the shedding
of blood there is no forgiveness of sins.

[23] Thus it was necessary for the copies of the heavenly
things to be purified with these rites, but the heavenly things
themselves with better sacrifices than these. [24] For Christ has
entered, not into holy places made with hands, which are cop-
ies of the true things, but into heaven itself, now to appear in
the presence of God on our behalf. [25] Nor was it to offer himself
repeatedly, as the high priest enters the holy places every year
with blood not his own, [26] for then he would have had to suffer

repeatedly since the foundation of the world. But as it is, he
has appeared once for all at the end of the ages to put away
sin by the sacrifice of himself. [27] And just as it is appointed for
man to die once, and after that comes judgment, [28] so Christ,
having been offered once to bear the sins of many, will appear
a second time, not to deal with sin but to save those who are
eagerly waiting for him.

10 For since the law has but a shadow of the good things to
come instead of the true form of these realities, it can never,
by the same sacrifices that are continually offered every year,
make perfect those who draw near. [2] Otherwise, would they
not have ceased to be offered, since the worshipers, having
once been cleansed, would no longer have any consciousness
of sins? [3] But in these sacrifices there is a reminder of sins every
year. [4] For it is impossible for the blood of bulls and goats to
take away sins.

[5] Consequently, when Christ came into the world, he said,

"Sacrifices and offerings you have not desired,
but a body have you prepared for me;
[6] in burnt offerings and sin offerings
you have taken no pleasure.
[7] Then I said, 'Behold, I have come to do your will,
O God,
as it is written of me in the scroll of the book.' "

[8] When he said above, "You have neither desired nor taken
pleasure in sacrifices and offerings and burnt offerings and
sin offerings" (these are offered according to the law), [9] then

he added, "Behold, I have come to do your will." He does away
with the first in order to establish the second. [10] And by that
will we have been sanctified through the offering of the body
of Jesus Christ once for all.

[11] And every priest stands daily at his service, offering
repeatedly the same sacrifices, which can never take away sins.
[12] But when Christ had offered for all time a single sacrifice for
sins, he sat down at the right hand of God, [13] waiting from that
time until his enemies should be made a footstool for his feet.
[14] For by a single offering he has perfected for all time those
who are being sanctified.

[15] And the Holy Spirit also bears witness to us; for after
saying,

[16] "This is the covenant that I will make with them
after those days, declares the Lord:
I will put my laws on their hearts,
and write them on their minds,"

[17] then he adds,

"I will remember their sins and their lawless deeds
no more."

[18] Where there is forgiveness of these, there is no longer any
offering for sin.

[19] Therefore, brothers, since we have confidence to enter the
holy places by the blood of Jesus, [20] by the new and living way
that he opened for us through the curtain, that is, through his

flesh, [21] and since we have a great priest over the house of God,
[22] let us draw near with a true heart in full assurance of faith,
with our hearts sprinkled clean from an evil conscience and
our bodies washed with pure water. [23] Let us hold fast the con-
fession of our hope without wavering, for he who promised
is faithful. [24] And let us consider how to stir up one another to
love and good works, [25] not neglecting to meet together, as is
the habit of some, but encouraging one another, and all the
more as you see the Day drawing near.

[26] For if we go on sinning deliberately after receiving the
knowledge of the truth, there no longer remains a sacrifice for
sins, [27] but a fearful expectation of judgment, and a fury of fire
that will consume the adversaries. [28] Anyone who has set aside
the law of Moses dies without mercy on the evidence of two
or three witnesses. [29] How much worse punishment, do you
think, will be deserved by the one who has trampled under-
foot the Son of God, and has profaned the blood of the cov-
enant by which he was sanctified, and has outraged the Spirit
of grace? [30] For we know him who said, "Vengeance is mine;
I will repay." And again, "The Lord will judge his people." [31] It
is a fearful thing to fall into the hands of the living God.

[32] But recall the former days when, after you were enlight-
ened, you endured a hard struggle with sufferings, [33] some-
times being publicly exposed to reproach and affliction, and
sometimes being partners with those so treated. [34] For you had
compassion on those in prison, and you joyfully accepted the
plundering of your property, since you knew that you your-
selves had a better possession and an abiding one. [35] Therefore

do not throw away your confidence, which has a great reward.
36 For you have need of endurance, so that when you have done
the will of God you may receive what is promised. 37 For,

"Yet a little while,
and the coming one will come and will not
delay;
38 but my righteous one shall live by faith,
and if he shrinks back,
my soul has no pleasure in him."

39 But we are not of those who shrink back and are destroyed,
but of those who have faith and preserve their souls.

11 Now faith is the assurance of things hoped for, the convic-
tion of things not seen. 2 For by it the people of old received
their commendation. 3 By faith we understand that the uni-
verse was created by the word of God, so that what is seen was
not made out of things that are visible.

4 By faith Abel offered to God a more acceptable sacrifice
than Cain, through which he was commended as righteous,
God commending him by accepting his gifts. And through
his faith, though he died, he still speaks. 5 By faith Enoch was
taken up so that he should not see death, and he was not
found, because God had taken him. Now before he was taken
he was commended as having pleased God. 6 And without faith
it is impossible to please him, for whoever would draw near to
God must believe that he exists and that he rewards those who
seek him. 7 By faith Noah, being warned by God concerning
events as yet unseen, in reverent fear constructed an ark for

the saving of his household. By this he condemned the world
and became an heir of the righteousness that comes by faith.

8 By faith Abraham obeyed when he was called to go out to
a place that he was to receive as an inheritance. And he went
out, not knowing where he was going. 9 By faith he went to live
in the land of promise, as in a foreign land, living in tents with
Isaac and Jacob, heirs with him of the same promise. 10 For he
was looking forward to the city that has foundations, whose
designer and builder is God. 11 By faith Sarah herself received
power to conceive, even when she was past the age, since she
considered him faithful who had promised. 12 Therefore from
one man, and him as good as dead, were born descendants as
many as the stars of heaven and as many as the innumerable
grains of sand by the seashore.

13 These all died in faith, not having received the things
promised, but having seen them and greeted them from afar,
and having acknowledged that they were strangers and exiles
on the earth. 14 For people who speak thus make it clear that
they are seeking a homeland. 15 If they had been thinking of
that land from which they had gone out, they would have had
opportunity to return. 16 But as it is, they desire a better coun-
try, that is, a heavenly one. Therefore God is not ashamed to
be called their God, for he has prepared for them a city.

17 By faith Abraham, when he was tested, offered up Isaac,
and he who had received the promises was in the act of offering
up his only son, 18 of whom it was said, "Through Isaac shall your
offspring be named." 19 He considered that God was able even to
raise him from the dead, from which, figuratively speaking, he

did receive him back. [20] By faith Isaac invoked future blessings
on Jacob and Esau. [21] By faith Jacob, when dying, blessed each of
the sons of Joseph, bowing in worship over the head of his staff.
[22] By faith Joseph, at the end of his life, made mention of the exo-
dus of the Israelites and gave directions concerning his bones.

[23] By faith Moses, when he was born, was hidden for three
months by his parents, because they saw that the child was
beautiful, and they were not afraid of the king's edict. [24] By
faith Moses, when he was grown up, refused to be called the
son of Pharaoh's daughter, [25] choosing rather to be mistreated
with the people of God than to enjoy the fleeting pleasures
of sin. [26] He considered the reproach of Christ greater wealth
than the treasures of Egypt, for he was looking to the reward.
[27] By faith he left Egypt, not being afraid of the anger of the
king, for he endured as seeing him who is invisible. [28] By faith
he kept the Passover and sprinkled the blood, so that the
Destroyer of the firstborn might not touch them.

[29] By faith the people crossed the Red Sea as on dry land,
but the Egyptians, when they attempted to do the same, were
drowned. [30] By faith the walls of Jericho fell down after they
had been encircled for seven days. [31] By faith Rahab the prosti-
tute did not perish with those who were disobedient, because
she had given a friendly welcome to the spies.

[32] And what more shall I say? For time would fail me to tell
of Gideon, Barak, Samson, Jephthah, of David and Samuel and
the prophets — [33] who through faith conquered kingdoms,
enforced justice, obtained promises, stopped the mouths of
lions, [34] quenched the power of fire, escaped the edge of the

sword, were made strong out of weakness, became mighty
in war, put foreign armies to flight. [35] Women received back
their dead by resurrection. Some were tortured, refusing to
accept release, so that they might rise again to a better life.
[36] Others suffered mocking and flogging, and even chains and
imprisonment. [37] They were stoned, they were sawn in two,
they were killed with the sword. They went about in skins of
sheep and goats, destitute, afflicted, mistreated — [38] of whom
the world was not worthy — wandering about in deserts and
mountains, and in dens and caves of the earth.

[39] And all these, though commended through their faith,
did not receive what was promised, [40] since God had provided
something better for us, that apart from us they should not
be made perfect.

12 Therefore, since we are surrounded by so great a cloud of
witnesses, let us also lay aside every weight, and sin which
clings so closely, and let us run with endurance the race that
is set before us, [2] looking to Jesus, the founder and perfecter of
our faith, who for the joy that was set before him endured the
cross, despising the shame, and is seated at the right hand of
the throne of God.

[3] Consider him who endured from sinners such hostility
against himself, so that you may not grow weary or faint-
hearted. [4] In your struggle against sin you have not yet resisted
to the point of shedding your blood. [5] And have you forgotten
the exhortation that addresses you as sons?

"My son, do not regard lightly the discipline of the
Lord,
nor be weary when reproved by him.
6 For the Lord disciplines the one he loves,
and chastises every son whom he receives."

7 It is for discipline that you have to endure. God is treating
you as sons. For what son is there whom his father does not
discipline? 8 If you are left without discipline, in which all have
participated, then you are illegitimate children and not sons.
9 Besides this, we have had earthly fathers who disciplined us
and we respected them. Shall we not much more be subject
to the Father of spirits and live? 10 For they disciplined us for a
short time as it seemed best to them, but he disciplines us for
our good, that we may share his holiness. 11 For the moment
all discipline seems painful rather than pleasant, but later it
yields the peaceful fruit of righteousness to those who have
been trained by it.

12 Therefore lift your drooping hands and strengthen your
weak knees, 13 and make straight paths for your feet, so that
what is lame may not be put out of joint but rather be healed.
14 Strive for peace with everyone, and for the holiness without
which no one will see the Lord. 15 See to it that no one fails to
obtain the grace of God; that no "root of bitterness" springs
up and causes trouble, and by it many become defiled; 16 that
no one is sexually immoral or unholy like Esau, who sold his
birthright for a single meal. 17 For you know that afterward,
when he desired to inherit the blessing, he was rejected,

for he found no chance to repent, though he sought it
with tears.

18 For you have not come to what may be touched, a blazing
fire and darkness and gloom and a tempest 19 and the sound
of a trumpet and a voice whose words made the hearers beg
that no further messages be spoken to them. 20 For they could
not endure the order that was given, "If even a beast touches
the mountain, it shall be stoned." 21 Indeed, so terrifying was
the sight that Moses said, "I tremble with fear." 22 But you have
come to Mount Zion and to the city of the living God, the
heavenly Jerusalem, and to innumerable angels in festal gath-
ering, 23 and to the assembly of the firstborn who are enrolled
in heaven, and to God, the judge of all, and to the spirits of
the righteous made perfect, 24 and to Jesus, the mediator of a
new covenant, and to the sprinkled blood that speaks a better
word than the blood of Abel.

25 See that you do not refuse him who is speaking. For if
they did not escape when they refused him who warned them
on earth, much less will we escape if we reject him who warns
from heaven. 26 At that time his voice shook the earth, but now
he has promised, "Yet once more I will shake not only the
earth but also the heavens." 27 This phrase, "Yet once more,"
indicates the removal of things that are shaken—that is,
things that have been made—in order that the things that
cannot be shaken may remain. 28 Therefore let us be grateful
for receiving a kingdom that cannot be shaken, and thus let
us offer to God acceptable worship, with reverence and awe,
29 for our God is a consuming fire.

13 Let brotherly love continue. [2]Do not neglect to show hospitality to strangers, for thereby some have entertained angels unawares. [3]Remember those who are in prison, as though in prison with them, and those who are mistreated, since you also are in the body. [4]Let marriage be held in honor among all, and let the marriage bed be undefiled, for God will judge the sexually immoral and adulterous. [5]Keep your life free from love of money, and be content with what you have, for he has said, "I will never leave you nor forsake you." [6]So we can confidently say,

"The Lord is my helper;
I will not fear;
what can man do to me?"

[7]Remember your leaders, those who spoke to you the word of God. Consider the outcome of their way of life, and imitate their faith. [8]Jesus Christ is the same yesterday and today and forever. [9]Do not be led away by diverse and strange teachings, for it is good for the heart to be strengthened by grace, not by foods, which have not benefited those devoted to them. [10]We have an altar from which those who serve the tent have no right to eat. [11]For the bodies of those animals whose blood is brought into the holy places by the high priest as a sacrifice for sin are burned outside the camp. [12]So Jesus also suffered outside the gate in order to sanctify the people through his own blood. [13]Therefore let us go to him outside the camp and bear the reproach he endured. [14]For here we have no lasting city, but we seek the city that is to come. [15]Through him then

let us continually offer up a sacrifice of praise to God, that is, the fruit of lips that acknowledge his name. [16]Do not neglect to do good and to share what you have, for such sacrifices are pleasing to God.

[17]Obey your leaders and submit to them, for they are keeping watch over your souls, as those who will have to give an account. Let them do this with joy and not with groaning, for that would be of no advantage to you.

[18]Pray for us, for we are sure that we have a clear conscience, desiring to act honorably in all things. [19]I urge you the more earnestly to do this in order that I may be restored to you the sooner.

[20]Now may the God of peace who brought again from the dead our Lord Jesus, the great shepherd of the sheep, by the blood of the eternal covenant, [21]equip you with everything good that you may do his will, working in us that which is pleasing in his sight, through Jesus Christ, to whom be glory forever and ever. Amen.

[22]I appeal to you, brothers, bear with my word of exhortation, for I have written to you briefly. [23]You should know that our brother Timothy has been released, with whom I shall see you if he comes soon. [24]Greet all your leaders and all the saints. Those who come from Italy send you greetings. [25]Grace be with all of you.